

Philipp Hilbert. *Technical Product Manager, e-commerce and data platforms.*

Positioning, Thirteen years driving product from requirements to production, now targeting B2B platform work at the intersection of e-commerce, data, and AI tooling.

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§ WHY RITHUM

Rithum sits at a scale few commerce platforms reach: 40,000 companies, \$50 billion in GMV, hundreds of channels. The operational complexity that creates is the kind I find genuinely interesting to untangle. The posting calls out integration-heavy environments, data workflows, and AI tooling as core to the work, which matches where I spend most of my time. The expectation that every PM uses AI to accelerate delivery is a cultural signal I look for.

That's the environment where careful prioritisation and fast iteration actually compound.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo requirements and documentation drafts
- **GitHub Copilot**, spec and acceptance criteria generation
- **Cursor**, code-assisted discovery
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **GPT**, stakeholder communications and data analysis
- **Gamma.app**, internal enablement materials
- **n8n**, agentic workflow design
- **Jira + Confluence**, backlog and documentation tooling

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

REST APIs, webhooks, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), PostgreSQL, MongoDB, SQL, Dagster, dbt, ETL pipelines, Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, Jenkins, GitLab, Azure DevOps, CI/CD, Git, Kafka, Figma, Miro, Matomo, MicroStrategy, Shopware.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Two-sided B2B marketplace matching construction firms with workers, built zero to one.

- Anonymity-until-payment model protecting both sides of the marketplace until commitment is confirmed.
 - WhatsApp and Telegram as the primary product surface; LLM agents across the funnel so one person runs the day-to-day.
 - Funnel and conversion analysis in SQL, full product lifecycle owned by one person.
 - Demonstrates the founder-mindset and end-to-end delivery ownership Rithum lists as a preferred qualification.
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT RITHUM

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Read every enhancement request, release note, and open Jira ticket I can get access to, then sit in on at least one client call and one engineering sync to understand where the current intake process breaks down.

WEEK 2

Structure the intake.

Draft a triage template for enhancement requests, agree the fields with the Senior PM and engineering leads, and run a backlog session to tag the top 20 open items against that template.

Ship the first output.

Own one scoped capability from refined user stories through acceptance criteria, release notes, and enablement materials, so the team has a full end-to-end artifact to review and improve.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Rithum team,

I am applying for the Technical Product Manager role. I have 13 years of product ownership, mostly in integration-heavy B2B environments: a payments platform acquired into the Sparkasse girocard ecosystem, an insurance SaaS serving reinsurers and brokers, a national labour-market analytics platform for policymakers, and a B2B procurement webshop built on Shopware for three AOK health insurers. The common thread across those roles is translating ambiguous operational requirements into precise user stories and acceptance criteria, then driving cross-functional teams through delivery.

The Rithum posting is specific about what the role requires day to day: intake and triage rhythms, end-to-end ownership from requirements through release notes and enablement materials, and close collaboration with engineering and data science on APIs and data workflows. At Bundesagentur für Arbeit I owned a national analytics platform where I introduced Dagster and dbt to replace manual quarterly imports, saving roughly 75% of the time per data update, and integrated test automation into the Jenkins pipeline to free QA capacity. At EMIL Group I shipped the Claims Center from concept to production while restructuring an 18-person delivery organisation that was losing engineers and client trust. Both required the same thing: clear written outputs, early risk surfacing, and consistent cross-functional alignment.

The e-commerce and platform signal in the posting is relevant to my background. I ran the Shopware migration for AOK ITSCare, covering three insurers and roughly 20,000 employees, from backlog refinement and user stories through acceptance criteria in Jira. That system is still in production. I understand the mechanics of integration-heavy platforms, including REST APIs, webhooks, authentication patterns, and payload design, and I read technical documentation as a routine part of scoping.

I use AI tooling the way the posting describes: Claude Code and GitHub Copilot for documentation and requirements drafts, GPT for data analysis and communication, Lovable for rapid prototyping, and n8n for agentic workflows. That is not a list I assembled for this application. It is how I have been working for the last two years.

I am based in Berlin, hold EU citizenship, and am available within four weeks. I would be glad to talk through how my background fits the platform and the team.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ PROFILE

Product Manager and Product Owner with 13 years of product ownership in integration-heavy B2B environments, including e-commerce, insurance SaaS, public-sector data platforms, defence AI, healthcare, and payments. I translate ambiguous business needs into precise user stories, acceptance criteria, and delivery plans, manage cross-functional teams through agile delivery (Scrum, Kanban, SAFe), and use AI tooling daily to accelerate documentation, requirements, and analysis.

§ HOW I WORK

- I leave my ego at home. I want to drive the decision, not to have the last word.
 - On a new product I spend a little to learn before spending a lot to build. Cheap experiments make expensive decisions safe(r).
 - Outcome over output. Producing something is not the achievement; it also has to fit a market, so I agree what would count as success before we build and check afterwards whether it happened.
 - I keep the whole value chain in view, not just the backlog. Defect-to-fix time is a product metric; architects and DevOps engineers build that chain, my job is to steer it into the right lanes.
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§ WORK EXPERIENCE

PRODUCT MANAGER, ROHDE & SCHWARZ, MUNICH / REMOTE | 07/2024 - 05/2025

Defence and aerospace. Internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme.

- Championed GitOps delivery and test automation with ArgoCD, reducing rollout time from days to 30 minutes across multinational teams, making the platform hotfix-capable.

- Redirected product strategy based on user workflow analysis, increasing pipeline runs by 200% by prioritising developer-code-first over UI-led design.
- Managed a cross-functional team of 15+ engineers and data scientists through Scrum in Jira and Confluence.

PRODUCT MANAGER, BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT, NUREMBERG /
REMOTE | 05/2023 - 07/2024

Public sector. National labour-market analytics platform for policymakers and researchers. Deputy IT Security Officer.

- Introduced Dagster and dbt so quarterly imports and new data indicators ran without manual intervention, saving roughly 75% of the time per data update.
- Integrated test automation into the Jenkins pipeline, freeing several QA hours per week, and migrated a bare-metal system fully into containers.

PRODUCT OWNER, CLINET PLATFORMS, BERLIN | 01/2023 - 07/2023

Healthcare. Mobile patient app for iOS and Android, piloted in hospitals.

- Cut roadmap to the top 10% of features against agreed success measures: user acceptance rose more than fivefold.
- Implemented the CGM interface into hospital information system workflows: digital anamnesis dropped from 30 minutes to 5 from form to database.

PRODUCT MANAGER, EMIL GROUP, BERLIN | 04/2022 - 12/2022

Insurance. B2B SaaS platform for insurers, reinsurers, brokers and underwriters.

- Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams: attrition fell from near-total exodus to a single departure.
- Shipped the Claims Center from concept to production. Cut time-to-market for a new insurance product from months to under a week.

PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION TEAM, SCHEIDT & BACHMANN FUEL & CONVENIENCE RETAIL, MÖNCHENGLADBACH | 09/2021 - 03/2022

Retail and payments, POS and forecourt systems.

- Moved research results into production across a matrix organisation in a fully SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM), BUNDESDRUCKEREI, BERLIN | 03/2021 - 06/2021

Government, secure data platform.

- Data structures and identity management for the Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY), AOK ITSCARE, FRANKFURT | 03/2019 - 05/2020

Health insurance. B2B procurement webshop built on Shopware for three AOK insurers and roughly 20,000 employees; still in production.

- Migrated a legacy e-commerce system to Shopware. Managed backlog refinement, user stories and acceptance criteria in Jira.

PROJECT LEAD, ENERCON, WISMAR / MAGDEBURG | 04/2019 - 12/2019

Wind energy, full site IT modernisation end to end.

PRODUCT OWNER, WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN, ISNY | 08/2017 - 06/2018

Healthcare, clinical network. Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER TRACK

FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER, CONSTRUCT8, LIMASSOL | 12/2025 - 06/2026

- Built a two-sided B2B marketplace zero to one: anonymity-until-payment model, WhatsApp and Telegram as the product surface, LLM agents across the funnel, funnel and conversion analysis in SQL.

CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER, QCRYPT AG, BERLIN | 01/2016 - 12/2021

- IT security, quantum-secure encryption. Shipped a three-layer product that installs in under two minutes to meet enterprise buyer requirements. Later Chair of the board.

CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO, SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES, BERLIN | 03/2018 - 08/2021

- Nanotechnology and agriculture. Took a fertiliser product from laboratory to investor rounds, owning financial planning and investor reporting.

FOUNDER AND CFO, KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS, BERLIN | 02/2013 - 11/2018

- Fintech, mobile group-based P2P payments. Built from zero, acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ SKILLS

Product Ownership: user stories, acceptance criteria, definition of done, epics, backlog refinement, sprint planning, sprint review, retrospective, story-point estimation, velocity and burndown, release planning, UAT, JIRA, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Product Management: continuous discovery, product vision and roadmap, prioritisation, MVP definition, PoC, A/B testing, user research and interviews, prototyping, go-to-market support.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt and context engineering, evaluation loops, human-in-the-loop design, AI governance, EU AI Act, Explainable AI (XAI); daily use of Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable, GPT, Gamma.app.

Analytics and Data: funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, ETL (extract, transform, load), Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

Technical Environments Owned: REST APIs, webhooks, Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, CI/CD, Jenkins, Git, GitLab, Azure DevOps, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), SQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Shopware.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAgile (Scaled Agile Framework), ART (agile release train), PI planning.

Governance and Business: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership and financial planning as CFO, ROI reasoning.

§ EDUCATION

DIPLOM-WIRTSCHAFTSINGENIEUR (INDUSTRIAL ENGINEERING AND MANAGEMENT, EQUIVALENT TO A MASTER'S DEGREE), TECHNISCHE UNIVERSITÄT BERLIN (TU BERLIN), GERMANY | 10/2006 - 09/2014

- Specialisation: Logistics. Thesis with Siemens AG Energy Service on balancing-power market profitability.

§ LANGUAGES

German (native speaker, C2) · English (C2, business and technical fluency)

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